Strong 2-♣ Opening

Open 2♣ on any hand containing 22 or more points.
OR, open 2♣ with a hand containing 19-21 points and with 9+ playing tricks.

There are several methods of responding. For these Deals use the 2♦ Negative for all hands with 7 or fewer points. Any other response shows 8 or more points.

The 2♣ bid is artificial; Opener's second bid describes her hand.
2NT shows a balanced 22-24 point hand
3NT shows a balanced 25-27 point hand
2 of a suit shows a 5-card or longer suit

With a very weak hand (0-3 points) Responder should bid the "second negative" at his second turn. This is usually 3♣, but if Opener bids 3♣ then it is 3♦. If Opener should bid 3♦ at his second turn the second negative bid is 3♥.

Later bidding depends on the partnership, but unless particular conventions are in use then later bidding is natural.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥Q

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣7

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦J

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣J

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥3

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A K Q 10 3
♥ A K 6
♦ 8 6
♣ A Q 4

♠ 9 6
♥ 9 3
♦ A K 10 9 3
♣ J 9 7 2



♠ 8 7 5
♥ Q J 10 4
♦ Q 5 4
♣ 10 8 5

♠ J 4 2
♥ 8 7 5 2
♦ J 7 2
♣ K 6 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♥Q

SOUTH has 5 points, so she responds 2♦ to NORTH's opening 2♣ bid.

NORTH bids his 5-card ♠ suit.

SOUTH is too good for the second negative, so she supports NORTH's ♠.

NORTH doesn't have enough to think about slam, so he signs off at 4♠.

Board 2
West Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 10 8 5 4 3 ♥ 10 8 3 ♦ K 10 ♣ 10 9 2	
♠ A Q ♥ K Q J 2 ♦ A Q 9 8 ♣ A K 4	N W E S	♠ K J 7 2 ♥ A 7 5 ♦ J 4 2 ♣ 6 5 3
	♠ 9 6 ♥ 9 6 4 ♦ 7 6 5 3 ♣ Q J 8 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♣	Pass	2NT	Pass
6NT			
All Pass			

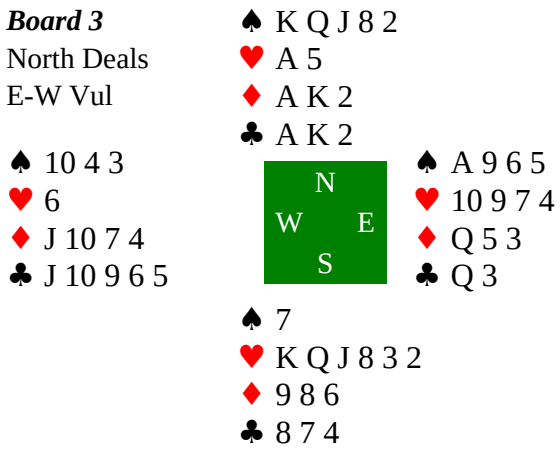
6NT by East
Lead: ♣7

WEST opens 2♣ with her balanced 25 points.

EAST has 9 points but no 5-card suit. He should make a positive response of 2NT.

WEST figures EAST for 8 points and bids 6NT. If EAST has significantly more than 8 it will be up to him to go to 7NT. But he doesn't.

Board 3
North Deals
E-W Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♥
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

6♥ by South
Lead: ♦J

NORTH opens 2♣ and SOUTH, with 8 points should bid 2♥.

NORTH should bid his ♠ suit at his second turn.

And SOUTH can only rebid the 6-card ♥s.

That's enough for NORTH to hear. He bids 6♥, or, just as good, he might bid 6NT.

Board 4
East Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 3 ♥ J 10 6 3 ♦ 9 8 4 ♣ J 10 8 4 2	
♠ A J 10 5 ♥ 8 5 ♦ Q 7 2 ♣ K Q 5 3	N W E S	♠ K Q 8 7 ♥ A K Q 2 ♦ A K J 6 ♣ 6
	♠ 9 6 4 2 ♥ 9 7 4 ♦ 10 5 3 ♣ A 9 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♣	Pass
2NT	Pass	3♣	Pass
3♠	Pass	4♠	Pass
6♠			
All Pass			

6♠ by West
Lead: ♣J

After EAST's 2♣ opening, WEST bids 2NT, showing a balanced hand of at least 8 points. WEST actually has 12 points, but the time to show the extra strength will be later.

EAST's 3♣ bid is Stayman, asking WEST for a 4-card Major. WEST mentions his ♠s and EAST bids 4♠, showing a minimum 2♣ opener with 4 ♠s.

Now WEST adds his 12 points to EAST's 22 minimum and gets 34. He bids 6♠.

Board 5
North Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ A K Q 6 3 ♥ A K 10 9 6 ♦ 10 6 ♣ A	
♠ J 5 4 ♥ 8 4 ♦ A K J 3 ♣ J 8 5 2		♠ 10 9 8 7 ♥ 7 3 ♦ Q 5 4 ♣ K Q 9 4
	♠ 2 ♥ Q J 5 2 ♦ 9 8 7 2 ♣ 10 7 6 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♣
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by North
Lead: ♥3

SOUTH has 3 points, so she responds 2♦ to NORTH's opening 2♣ bid, then bids 3♣ as a second-negative when NORTH bids 2♠.

However, when NORTH then bids ♥s, SOUTH finds two more points and bids 4♥.